

BIBLICAL PATTERNS OF MASCULINITY AND FEMININITY CHART

Pattern	God & Wisdom	Creator & Creation	Adam & Eve
1. The masculine is first and alone.	God and His wisdom are both eternal ordered “before” before “before” natural law (Proverbs 8:22–31).	The Trinity was complete before creating and, before creation, needed nothing (John 17:24).	Adam was created first and established in the garden alone.
2. The feminine comes from the masculine.	God brought forth (created) wisdom before the rest of creation (Proverbs 8:22–31).	Creation is born from God. He made it from nothing.	Woman was made from man’s side (Genesis 2).
3. The feminine reflects the masculine but is separate from the masculine.	Wisdom is variable/reflected, yet God’s image, or a godlike one.	God is not the universe; pantheism is wrong. God is a creator while creation is his work.	Although made for the man, woman was the full image of God apart from man (Genesis 1:27; 2:18).
4. The feminine is created for the masculine as helper, companion, fruitbearer, and glorifier.	Wisdom was God’s companion at creation (Proverbs 8:30–31).	The heavens are God’s tent; the earth is His footstool (Isaiah 66:1). Creation glorifies God by reflecting him (Psalm 19:1–4; Romans 1:20–23).	God gave Eve to Adam to help and complete him (Genesis 2:18).
5. Masculine initiation and feminine response unify the two.	God initiated creation and wisdom responded. She helped and shared in the act (Proverbs 8:30–31).	God made the action with the creative act and Mary at the Incarnation of Christ, who is both Creator and created (John 1:1–3).	Sexual union is the consummating act of marriage (1 Corinthians 7:2–5).
6. Union produces fruit in the image of both the providing father and the nurturing mother.	God created the world not to return to His image but to reveal His glory (Proverbs 8:22–31; Isaiah 43:7).	God rules the world and provides for “mother nature”; she produces fruit in all its forms.	The union of Adam and Eve resulted in laboring and children.
7. The masculine and feminine mature as they co-labor, fellowship, and bear fruit.	Neither God nor wisdom matures. God progressively reveals Himself. Wisdom is progressively interpreted by man.	God provides and the world is created (Psalm 104). Creation “grows” in fulfillment, awaiting God’s Kingdom (Romans 8:19–23).	Adam and Eve progressively mature prior to being fruitful (cf. Romans 12:2–6).
8. Glory and dwelling are perfected in each other.	Although eternal in creation, wisdom finally dwells with God alone (Job 28:12–28).	The once renewed Creation and creation dwell in harmony and glory in New Heaven and Earth (Revelation 21–22).	Adam and Eve are naked in heaven. He is the final head of the race; she is the mother of all living (Genesis 3:20).

BIBLICAL PATTERNS OF MASCULINITY AND FEMININITY CHART — CONTINUED

Pattern	God & Israel	Christ & the Church	Men & Women
1. The masculine is first and alone.	God was the God of all nations before Israel existed (Genesis 1–11).	Christ was before the Church in His divinity and His humanity.	A man should establish something of his own identity, territory, and livelihood before seeking a wife.
2. The feminine comes from the masculine.	God created Israel supernaturally from barren people (Genesis 12–50; Ezekiel 16:5–6).	The Church is built of Christ's body and blood (John 6:53–58; 19:34; 1 Corinthians 11:23–30).	A man should look for a suitable wife and be willing to sacrifice to get her.
3. The feminine reflects the masculine but is separate from the masculine.	Israel represents God but is not God. She has often rebelled (Deuteronomy 4:6–8; Isaiah 1:4; Romans 9:3–5).	The mature Church reflects Christ's image (Ephesians 4:12–13; Romans 8:29). The Church remains human and is not divine.	As an individual image of God, woman should mature in her own identity. She should not be merely a leaner.
4. The feminine is created for the masculine as helper, companion, fruitbearer, and glorifier.	Israel was created to be God's unique possession, companion (dwelling with Him), and glorifier (Deuteronomy 4:20).	A gift of the Father to the Son, the Church is Christ's body, helper, fruitbearer, and glorifier.	A woman should view marriage as a commitment to help her man in his work and person.
5. Masculine initiation and feminine response unify the two.	God gave the Law and the tabernacle. Israel was steward of the law and the tabernacle.	The Church is to be a pure virgin for Christ, not adulterous with the world (1 Corinthians 11:2–3; James 4:4).	Marital union is enacted in sexual relations and fostered through long-term cohabitation (1 Corinthians 7:1–5).
6. Union produces fruit in the image of both the providing father and the nurturing mother.	God and Israel produced the Kingdom of God (1446–586 B.C.), the Bible, and Christ.	Abiding in Christ produces fruit—evangelism, good works, and glory to God (John 15:1–11).	Ideally, marital union produces children, adequate wealth, Christian testimony, and service.
7. The masculine and feminine mature as they co-labor, fellowship, and bear fruit.	Israel's maturity is certain, though rebellion has caused a temporary blindness (Ezekiel 16:46–63; Romans 11:25–29).	Christ is progressively revealed and the Church is progressively perfected through the centuries (Ephesians 4:11–16).	The usual path to human maturity is perseverance in married life (1 Timothy 3:2–5; 5:9–10).
8. Glory and dwelling are perfected in each other.	God will dwell in Zion and glorify her. She will dwell secure and be His glory (Isaiah 4:4–6; 60–66; Revelation 21:10–27).	The Church is Christ's glory. He is hers. He dwells in her; she abides in Him (Revelation 19:7–9; 21:2–3, 9–11).	Ideally, an older couple dwells in harmony and enjoys the fruit of their lifetime of labors.